PRODUCTION STANDARD

Voice Direction Standard

How to make a synthetic voice sound like a person explaining something to a friend.

Easywurld · Lagos, Nigeria
Applies to every voiceover in the social library
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VOICE

Making a synthetic voice sound like a person

A robotic voiceover is almost never the voice engine’s fault. It is the script. Written language and spoken language have different rhythms, and most AI voiceovers are read from text that was written to be seen, not heard.

> The whole method in one line: write for the ear, and use punctuation as a timing control. Everything below is detail on those two things.

1 · Punctuation is a timing control, measured

Two versions of the same script were generated for this pack and measured. The only difference was punctuation.

Version	Punctuation used	Pause after a beat	Total length
A	Periods and commas only	220–490 ms	19.8 s
B	Em-dashes and ellipses added	560–860 ms	22.0 s

The same words, two seconds longer, with pauses twice as long. That difference is what reads as “thinking” rather than “reading”. Use it deliberately:

— Em-dash (—) for a held beat — roughly 0.7 seconds. Use before a reveal.

— Ellipsis (...) for a softer pause — roughly 0.5 seconds. Use mid-thought.

— Full stop for a normal stop. Never use three in a row unless you want a long gap.

— Comma for the shortest beat. If you need a breath, a comma is usually not enough.

— Line break between paragraphs adds an even longer gap. Use it as a scene change.

2 · Write for the ear, not the page

Instead of	Write
“It is important to note that pricing is not the primary issue.”	“It’s almost never the price.”
“Utilise a three-part communication structure.”	“Say three things.”
“Customers frequently disengage following price quotation.”	“You send the price. They vanish.”
“Our comprehensive playbook provides 36 scripts.”	“I put thirty-six of them in one file.”

— Contractions, always. “It is” sounds like a memo. “It’s” sounds like a person.

— Sentences under 12 words. A sentence you cannot say in one breath is too long to hear.

— One idea per sentence. Two ideas per sentence is where synthetic voices flatten out.

— Numbers as words where rhythm matters: “thirty-six”, not “36”. Keep figures as numerals when precision matters: “₦5,000”.

— Speak the punctuation you want. If you want a pause, type one. It will not invent drama.

3 · The seven-second rule

Listen to the first seven seconds alone. If it sounds like an announcement — even, polished, no change in energy — regenerate it before you build the video. The opening is the only part most people will hear, and it is the part that decides whether the rest is heard at all.

4 · Where synthetic voices still fail, and the workaround

Failure	Why it happens	The workaround
Emphasis on the wrong word	The engine guesses which word carries the stress	Put the stressed word in its own short sentence. Do not rely on capitals or asterisks.
Flat emotion across a joke	Written jokes need timing a flat read cannot invent	Write the pause in. Put the punchline on its own line, after a line break.
Names and places mispronounced	Nigerian names are often absent from pronunciation dictionaries	Spell phonetically in the script (“Oluwaseun” “Oh-loo-wah-shay-oon”), then fix in the edit.
Rushing the last sentence	Engines accelerate toward the end of a paragraph	End on a short sentence. Six words or fewer.
Identical rhythm every time	One model, one cadence	Vary script length between videos. A 20-second script and a 35-second script breathe differently.

5 · The delivery notation used in this system

Every voiceover in the social library carries the same three columns. That is what makes a re-record possible months later without re-deciding anything.

Column	What it holds	Example
Line	The exact words. Nothing else.	“And then — nothing.”
Pace	A number: words slower or faster than normal.	0.55 = slower than normal
Direction	What the voice is doing, in plain language.	“drop in volume, leave the silence”

6 · When you are ready to be the voice

A synthetic voice is a placeholder that buys you time. The day you can record yourself, do it — a real voice, even an imperfect one, outperforms a good synthetic voice on trust, and trust is what makes a ₦5,000 pack feel safe to buy.

— Record in a small room with soft surfaces: curtains, a bed, a wardrobe full of clothes.

— Phone on a stand, 20cm away, slightly off-axis so plosives miss the mic.

— Record standing up. It changes the breath and the energy more than any plugin.

— Do three takes of the first line only. Keep the third — it is always the most natural.

— Leave two seconds of silence at the start. It makes editing in CapCut trivial.

> The goal is not to sound excited. It is to sound like you understand what you are saying. Everything in this document serves that one thing.